

Assignment Brief: Assisting with Activities of Daily Living (ADLs) and Personal Support

Course/Module: Meet personal support needs

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research.**

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:

Before assisting a client with their daily morning routine, what steps must a care worker take to review the care plan, and why is it essential to confirm the resident's specific preferences, cultural needs, and current functional capabilities prior to providing care?

Question 2:

Describe the correct procedure for providing oral care to a resident who is dependent or unable to perform their own mouth care. What specific body positioning and safety precautions are required to prevent fluid aspiration and protect the resident's airway?

Question 3:

Outline the hygienic step-by-step process for removing, cleaning, and storing a resident's dentures. What specific precaution should be taken at the sink to prevent accidental damage or breakage if the dentures are dropped during cleaning?

Question 4:

When assisting a resident who has weakness or paralysis on one side (such as following a stroke), what is the standard sequence for which limb to dress first and undress first? Explain how this technique minimizes joint strain and discomfort.

Question 5:

How can a care worker assist a resident with grooming tasks (such as shaving, hair styling, or nail care) while respecting their personal preferences, adult status, and self-determination regarding their appearance?

Question 6:

Explain the key principles of providing dignified mealtime assistance to a resident who requires feeding support. What seating posture, feeding pace, and communication strategies must care staff use to ensure safety, foster social connection, and prevent choking?

Question 7:

Assisting with daily bathing and dressing provides an ideal opportunity to monitor skin integrity. What early clinical indicators of skin breakdown or pressure injuries should a care worker look for, and which anatomical areas are at the highest risk?

Question 8:

What is the difference between "doing for" a resident and "enabling" them during ADL assistance? Why is encouraging residents to complete tasks independently (even if it takes longer) vital for maintaining their physical function and cognitive well-being?

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Question 9:

Personal hygiene procedures can make residents feel vulnerable. What practical steps should care staff take before and during bathing or dressing to maintain the resident's physical privacy, thermal comfort, and emotional security?

Question 10:

If a care worker notices a sudden decline in a resident's physical capability to perform a daily task (such as losing the ability to grasp a spoon or button a cardigan), what immediate documentation and reporting steps must be taken?

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**, assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.